



It's more fun in the
Philippines

MINDANAO
FUN 101

MINDANAO FUN 101

ABOUT THE COVER

The surging waters of surf central Siargao, pictured on the cover, is just one beginning. Or the midpoint. Or the perfect ending of a journey whose time has come.

Now is the moment to map out your Mindanao fun. Book those tickets. Do the reservations. Get yourself ready.

Bags...camera...action!





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CLIMB towards gorgeousness,
your reward for reaching the top.

01
LAKE HOLON
Mount Parker, T'boli,
South Cotabato

What to expect
Amazing forest sights as you
go on a 3 to 4-hour trek.
Bracing lake water temperatures.

What to do
Swim in the lake.
Camp through the night.

What to wear
Comfortable clothes.
Proper hiking shoes.
Trousers to protect you
from sharp, itchy grass.
A thick jacket for the evening.
Apply mosquito repellent
as you go along.

When to go
Philippine summer season.

How to get there
From Davao City, take a bus
to Koronadal, South Cotabato.
The trip takes 2 to 3 hours.
From Koronadal, take a van
with the sign "Direct T'boli"
for a 1-hour trip to the
Municipal Tourism Office.
From there, another 1-hour
skylab trip is needed to reach
the starting point of the trek.

It pays to know
All visitors are required to register
at the Municipal Tourism Office.
Official local guides are waiting
to help you with your trek.
Porters can also be hired
if you need them.

DESTINATIONS



EMBRACE the sun-soaked pleasures of this spectacular sandbar.

02 WHITE ISLAND

1.4 kilometers off Camiguin.

What to expect

Fine white sand.
Sunrise and sunset views.
Clear blue waters.
Panoramic vista of Mt. Hibok–Hibok and Mt. Vulcan.

What to do

Swim, sunbathe, snorkel.
Dive and explore the surrounding reefs, including a black coral area on one side of the sand bar.

What to wear

Beach clothes, wide-brimmed hats.
Bring sunblock lotion and umbrella.

When to go

Philippine summer season.

How to get there

There are flights from Cebu City to Camiguin, or you can choose to fly to Cagayan de Oro City. Take a shuttle to Agora Terminal where a bus will take you to Balingoan Port. Take a ferry to Benoni Port in Camiguin. From the port, take a tricycle to Barangay Yumbing, where motorized boats await.

It pays to know

The heat can get really intense by midday. Consider an early morning or a late afternoon trip to the sandbar.

For more information

<http://www.camiguin.gov.ph/>



SEEK out the rugged beauty of the country's most southeasterly point.

03

CAPE SAN AGUSTIN
Sitio Talisay, Barangay Lavigan,
Governor Generoso, Davao Oriental

What to expect
Stunning beaches.
Dramatic coastline.
Historical landmarks dating back to the Spanish colonial era.

What to do
Swim, walk around, breathe in the view.

What to wear
Comfortable clothes,
beachwear, sunblock.

When to go
Philippine summer season.

How to get there
From the Davao City
Overland Transport Terminal,
take a bus to Governor Generoso
town.

It pays to know
Waterproof bags and backpacks
are highly recommended when
trekking through the coastline.

For more information
Governor Generoso
Municipal Tourism Office
+6382440354



MARVEL at the miracle of a tower surviving the challenges of time.

04 **BANZA CHURCH RUINS**
Sitio Lilo, Butuan City

What to expect
Mindanao's oldest church ruins in Butuan's oldest inhabited area. Imposing, centuries-old baobab tree. Panoramic view of Agusan River. Peace and quiet.

What to do
Daytime picnic. Take loads of pictures. Meditate.

What to wear
Comfortable clothes, sensible footwear.

When to go
Year-round destination but avoid going during the typhoon season.

How to get there
Fly to Butuan City from Manila. Take a tricycle to Busa from the city center, where you take another tricycle ride to Sitio Lilo.

It pays to know
Find those Busa tricycles that look like mini-jeepneys. Just tell the driver to take you to Ruins.



SOAK in the majesty and magic of the country's highest water cascade.

05

ALIWAGWAG FALLS

Barangay Aliwagwag,
Cateel, Davao Oriental

What to expect

Astonishing waterfalls and rock formation. Centuries-old trees. Lush forest environment.

What to do

Swim, have fun, relax. Try Sawugnun, a slightly bitter-tasting fish the locals traditionally stew in vinegar (paksiw).

What to wear

Quick-drying outfits, swimwear, sunblock. Bring extra clothes to change into. You'll probably get wet even if you don't intend to swim.

When to go

Year-round destination but avoid going during the typhoon season.

How to get there

From Davao City take a 5-hour bus ride to Cateel town. Aliwagwag is 20 minutes away from the town center. If you're taking a private vehicle, drive through the Compostela Valley Road or Mati Road straight to the site.



TREASURE the sight
of the planet's fiercest winged creature.

06 PHILIPPINE EAGLE CENTER Malagos, Baguio District, Davao City

What to expect

Philippine eagle, other bird species.
Exotic mammals and reptiles.
A glimpse into the Philippines' forest eco-system.

What to do

Observe how Philippine eagles are taken care of.
Walk through a simulated tropical rainforest environment.

What to wear

Comfortable clothes, sensible footwear.
Wide-brimmed hats and eyewear to protect yourself from fruit flies.

When to go

Year-round destination.

How to get there

From the city center, ride a bus from Annil Terminal at San Pedro Extension. You can also take a jeepney from Agdao or Bankerohan markets. Upon reaching Calinan, take a 10-minute tricycle ride to the Center. You can also ride a taxi all the way.

It pays to know

Call the Center in advance for the picture-taking schedule with the eagles.



REFRESH your body and mind
with water spouting forth from a mountainside.

07 ASIK-ASIK FALLS Sitio Dulao, Brgy. Dado, Alamada town, North Cotabato

What to expect

Refreshing alkaline water.
Between 5 to 25-meter high waterfalls,
cascading gently from different points
of a 200-meter wide mountainside.

What to do

Ride a motorbike through exciting terrain.
Enjoy the view as you walk down
375 paved steps to reach the falls.

What to wear

Comfortable clothes, athletic footwear.
Apply insect repellent before your trek.

When to go

Philippine summer season.

How to get there

Take buses that ply
the Davao City–Cotabato City route.
Get down at Barangay Libungan.
Take a jeepney to Alamada and
head straight to the Tourism Office
for registration. The office can also
arrange for guides to take you to the falls.

It pays to know

There are no resort facilities in the area.
Bring everything you need for a picnic or a swim.



SEE the elements of a town's
heritage, put together for your
viewing pleasure.

09 SUBANGAN MUSEUM Mati City, Davao Oriental

What to expect

The world's 7th largest
sperm whale skeleton on display.
A showcase of the area's
natural history and traditional culture.

When to go

Year-round destination.

How to get there

Fly from Manila or Cebu to Davao.
Take a bus to Mati City.
The museum is 5 minutes away
from Mati's central area.

It pays to know

Follow museum rules
and regulations.
Ask the staff before you take
pictures of items on exhibit.



HIKE around and take in
the air of this mountain of
adventure.

08 DAHILAYAN ADVENTURE PARK AND DAHILAYAN FOREST PARK Barangay Dahilayan, Manolo Fortich, Bukidnon

What to expect

Mountaintop day resort.
Cool weather, pine trees,
abundant flora.

What to do

Walk around, run, chill.
Zip through Asia's longest
dual zipline.
Enjoy the freshest mountain air.

What to wear

Comfortable clothes.
sensible footwear,
a light jacket.

When to go

Year-round destination.

How to get there

Fly from Manila, Cebu or Davao to
Cagayan de Oro City.
Take a jeepney or van from
Agora Terminal to Camp Philips,
then take a habal-habal ride to the
site.

It pays to know

Expect a bumpy ride from
Camp Philips to Dahilayan.



SAIL through stories
of pre–history,
rescued from the depths of the
earth.

10

BUTUAN MUSEUM
Butuan City

What to expect
World–famous balanghai
(Butuan boats) dating back
to the 4th century AD.
Valuable artifacts,
Archeological finds.
An enriched appreciation of
the country’s pre–colonial past.

When to go
Year–round destination.
Monday – Friday:
9:00 AM to 4:00 PM
Saturday, Sunday, holidays:
by special appointment.

How to get there
Fly from Manila or Cebu.
Take a bus from
Davao or Cagayan de Oro.
The museum is just 5 kilometers.
from Butuan City center.

It pays to know
Follow museum rules
and regulations.
Ask the museum staff
before you take pictures
of the items on display.



LEARN how life in exile made a man out of a hero.

11 RIZAL SHRINE Talisay, Dapitan City

What to expect

A 16–hectare estate conceived at turn of the 20th century. A showcase of practical genius by the country’s national hero.

What to do

Stroll through 4 years of Dr. Jose Rizal’s life. See enduring examples of his architectural, engineering, and carpentry pursuits. Visit the rock named Mi Retiro, where the hero spent a lot of special moments with his sweetheart, Josephine Bracken.

What to wear

Comfortable clothes.

When to go

Philippine summer season.

How to get there

Fly from Manila or Cebu to Dipolog City. From the airport, take a 15–minute van or bus ride to the shrine.

It pays to know

Experience hilot, a traditional therapeutic massage, offered by Rizal devotees near the shrine.



FEEL the zeal of Catholicism, weathering the storms of centuries.

13 CARAGA CHURCH Caraga, Davao Oriental

What to expect

The oldest surviving Catholic church in Mindanao. Awe–inspiring view of the Pacific Ocean. Centuries–old giant seashells serving as fonts for holy water. Baptismal registry with entries dating back to 1835.

What to wear

Avoid wearing skimpy clothes.

When to go

Year–round destination but avoid going during the typhoon season.

How to get there

Take a bus–
5 hours from Davao City,
3 hours from Mati.

For more information
info@caragatourism.com

SAVOR the gifts and grace of paradise regained.

12 EDEN NATURE PARK Toril District, Davao City

What to expect

Deer park. Bird walk. Manmade forest. Organic herb and vegetable gardens. Fields of exotic plants, pines, and fruit trees.

What to do

Daytime picnic, short treks around. Overnight stay at well–appointed cottages.

What to wear

Comfortable clothes, sensible footwear, a light jacket.

When to go

Year–round destination.

How to get there

Take a taxi or a jeepney.

It pays to know

Have an early start, it usually rains in the afternoons.



EXPLORE life at sea, with shipwreck treasures and marine bounty.

14 ZAMBOANGA NATIONAL MUSEUM Fort Pilar, Pilar Street, Zamboanga City

What to expect

Galleon treasures and artifacts. Fishing tools, musical instruments. Paintings, cultural memorabilia. A display of the peninsula’s rich marine life.

What to wear

Comfortable clothes.

When to go

Year–round destination.

How to get there

From the city’s airport, ride a jeepney or tricycle to Fort Pilar.

For more information

National Museum– Zamboanga
+63 62 9916029





IMAGINE a force from above,
humbling the might of spirit
and stone.

15

GUIOB CHURCH RUINS

Barangay Bonbon,
Catarman, Camiguin

What to expect

Evidence of the destructive force
Mt. Vulcan's eruption in the 1800s.
Surviving remains of a
church complex including
massive walls, columns,
the bell tower, the convent.

What to do

Walk around, picnic.
Attend a mass service
in a small chapel built
inside the ruins.

What to wear

Comfortable clothes.

When to go

April to September.

How to get there:

There are flights from Cebu City
straight to Camiguin.
Or fly to Cagayan de Oro City
and take a shuttle to Agora
Terminal.
Ride a bus to Balingoan Port.
Take a ferry to Benoni Port in
Camiguin.

It pays to know

There is no visitor's fee,
but a donation box is placed
at the entrance to help the locals
maintain the area.

EXPERIENCE devotion,
pilgrimage, and monumental
fervor.

16 EL SALVADOR
Divine Mercy Hills,
El Salvador City, Misamis Oriental

What to expect
The world's tallest
Divine Mercy statue.
Divine Mercy Church.
Various religious activities.

What to do
Take part in the
daily mass service.
Go to confession.
Attend counseling,
prayer healing sessions
every Saturday.

What to wear
Casual, modest attire.

When to go
Year-round destination.
A trip on weekends or
during Holy Week is
recommended.

How to get there
Fly from Manila or Cebu
to Cagayan de Oro.
Take a taxi or fixed-rate van.

It pays to know
The shrine administration is strict
about the dress code.



ADMIRE the art, the architecture,
and the faith that sustains such
beauty.

17 JIMENEZ CHURCH
Jimenez, Misamis Occidental

What to expect
One of the country's
oldest Catholic churches.
Impressive antique altar,
Gothic-inspired pillars.
Well-preserved, fascinating
paintings on the church's ceilings.

What to wear
Casual, modest attire.

When to go
Year-round destination.

How to get there
There are flights from Manila,
boat trips from Cebu,
and buses from Cagayan de Oro
that will take you to Ozamiz City.

It pays to know
Ask permission from the caretaker
before you start taking pictures.



LOUNGE the day in peace,
on sand kissed by shades of
pink.

18

SANTA CRUZ ISLAND
Across Zamboanga City

What to expect

Pink coralline sand beach.
Cool azure waters.
Spectacular mangrove sanctuary.
Traditional cemetery of the
Badjaos, the sea gypsies of
Mindanao.

What to do

Daytime picnic.
Swim, sunbathe, laze around.
Have a guided exploration
of the mangrove forest.

What to wear

Summer clothes,
swimwear, sensible footwear.

When to go

Philippine summer season.

How to get there

Take a motorized boat from
Paseo del Mar in Zamboanga City.
It takes 15 to 20 minutes to reach
the island.

It pays to know

Bring your own food and beverage.
Leave early in the morning
to maximize your day at the island.
Visitors are advised to sail back
to Zamboanga City before sunset.





19

CHALLENGE your limits
with this amazing, life-
changing climb.

**MOUNT KITANGLAD
RANGE NATURAL PARK**

Between Malaybalay City
and the municipalities
of Lantapan, Impasug-ong,
Sumilao, and Libona

What to expect:

The country's fourth highest
mountain.
Amazing biodiversity and topography.
Sublime views of Bukidnon,
Macajalar Bay, Camiguin Island,
and Mount Dulang-Dulang.

What to do:

A 2-day trek to the summit.
Observe up close a lush tropical
rainforest environment.
Spot different species of birds.
See the stalactite and stalagmites
of Panyak Caves.
Have a heaven-sent dip in
the many lakes and hot springs
along the way.

What to wear:

Expert-approved climbing gear.

When to go:

Year-round destination.

How to get there:

From the cities of Cagayan de Oro,
and Davao, a 24-hour bus service
passes through the Malaybalay City
Terminal.

From there, take a tricycle (motorela)
to the DENR-PENRO compound.
Register and be guided through
the particulars of your trek.

It pays to know:

You are required to file a visitor's
permit at the Office of Protected Area
& Management Bureau (PAMB)
10 days prior to the actual date of
visit.



ENCOUNTER Islamic glory
in the country's largest place of
prayer.

20

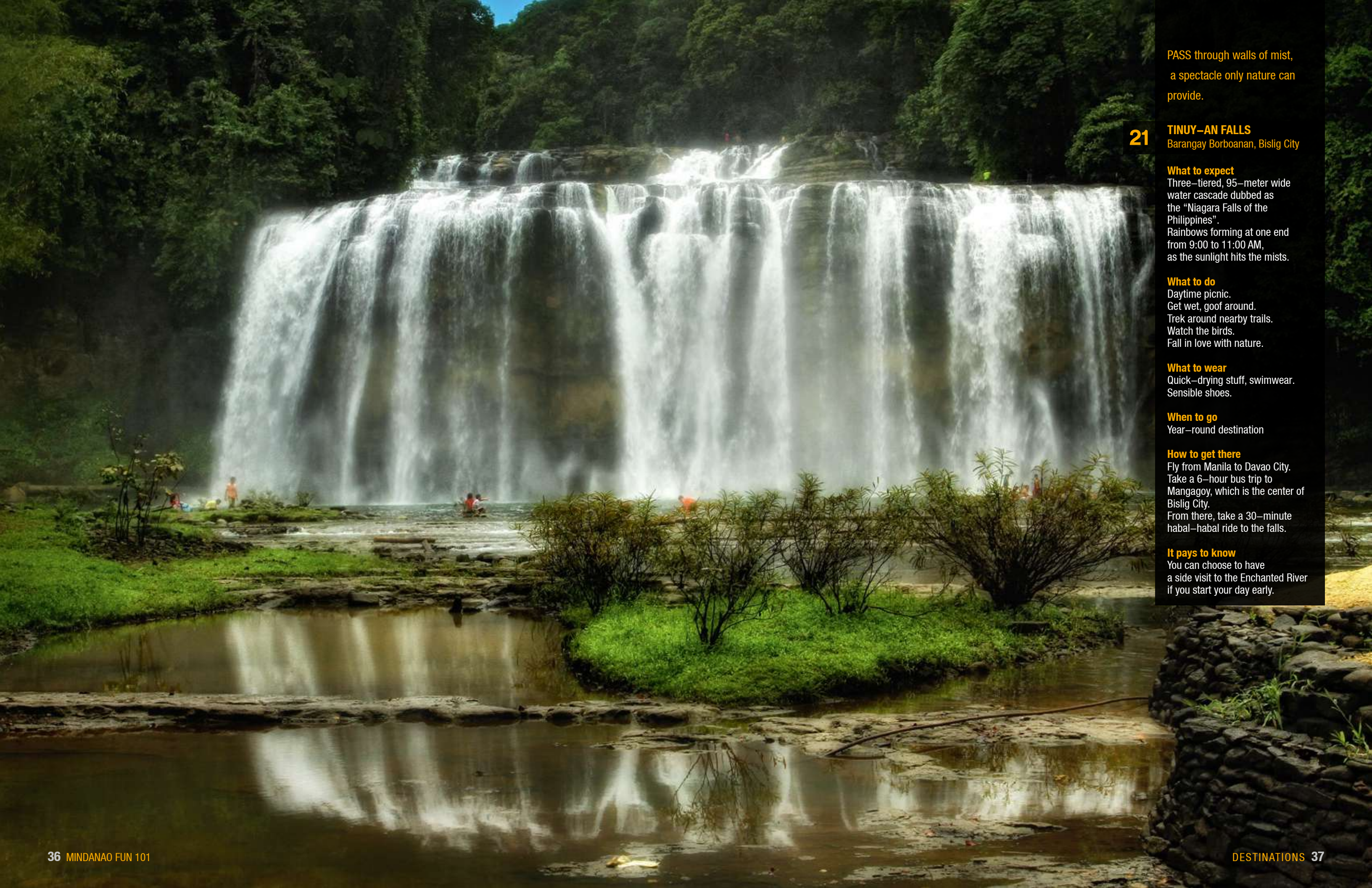
**COTABATO CITY
GRAND MOSQUE**
Barangay Kalanganan Dos,
Cotabato City

What to expect
Marvelous architecture
of white walls and
golden yellow domes.
Space for 800 male
and 400 female worshippers.
Sprawling grounds.

What to wear
Decent, modest clothes.

When to go
Year-round destination.

How to get there
Fly from Manila,
or take a bus from Davao City.
Upon reaching Cotabato City,
a multicab or a jeepney
from the downtown area
will take you to the mosque.



21

PASS through walls of mist,
a spectacle only nature can
provide.

TINUUY-AN FALLS
Barangay Borboanan, Bislig City

What to expect
Three-tiered, 95-meter wide
water cascade dubbed as
the “Niagara Falls of the
Philippines”.
Rainbows forming at one end
from 9:00 to 11:00 AM,
as the sunlight hits the mists.

What to do
Daytime picnic.
Get wet, goof around.
Trek around nearby trails.
Watch the birds.
Fall in love with nature.

What to wear
Quick-drying stuff, swimwear.
Sensible shoes.

When to go
Year-round destination

How to get there
Fly from Manila to Davao City.
Take a 6-hour bus trip to
Mangagoy, which is the center of
Bislig City.
From there, take a 30-minute
habal-habal ride to the falls.

It pays to know
You can choose to have
a side visit to the Enchanted River
if you start your day early.



STROLL through the past,
with traditions passed on through generations.

23 FORT PILAR

Zone IV, Zamboanga City

What to expect

17th century bastion of Spanish colonial rule.
A Marian shrine with devotees lighting candles, seeking the intercession of Nuestra Señora del Pilar.
The renewed National Museum of the Philippines' regional outpost.

What to wear

Casual, modest clothes.

When to go

Year-round destination
October is the best month to go as the entire city celebrates the festival of its Catholic patroness.

How to get there

Regular flights from Manila, Cebu, and Davao City.
From the city's airport, ride a jeepney or tricycle to Fort Pilar.

It pays to know

Know a bit of Spanish? Then you'll have an easier time with the local tongue.
Zamboanga's Chabacano is generously filled with Spanish words and phrases.



HEED the call for prayerful silence,
in a space inspired by the divine.

22 BENEDICTINE MONASTERY OF THE TRANSFIGURATION

Barangay San Jose, Malaybalay City

What to expect

Imposing pyramidal structure perched on top of a hill.
Affable Benedictine monks.
Museum of Transfiguration Monastery, featuring a collection of liturgical vestments created by fashion designer-turned-monk, Dom Martin de Jesus.
Magnificent view of the mountains of Bukidnon.

What to do

Pray, meditate, feel the peace.
Attend mass service on weekends.
Join the Breakfast with the Monks every second Sunday of the month, a buffet specially prepared by these pious men for mass-goers.
Sample the famous Monks' Blend premium coffee, peanut butter, and sweet peanut brittle.

What to wear

Decent, modest clothes.

When to go

Year-round destination.

How to get there

Take a bus to Malaybalay from Cagayan de Oro City or Davao City

It pays to know

The church design was conceived by Leandro Locsin, National Artist for Architecture.



HONOR the hallowed halls
of the country's oldest Islamic site of worship.

24 SIMUNUL MOSQUE

Tubig Indangan, Simunul, Tawi–Tawi

What to expect

Site of the mosque built by an Arab trader in 1380. The original pillars can still be seen inside the newer structure. Islamic culture and traditions. Small nearby islands with exquisite beaches.

What to wear

Decent clothes. When going to the beaches, women must avoid wearing skimpy outfits. A rash guard is ideal for those who want to take a dip.

When to go

December to March to avoid both the hot and rainy seasons.

How to get there

From the main island of Bongao, take the boat that goes to Tubig Indangan. Be prepared to stay overnight. Trips to Simunul are available only between 11:00 AM to 12:00 NN. Return trips are scheduled at 8:00 AM the next day.

It pays to know

If you have a bit more time, the rest of the Tawi–tawi islands are worth exploring.

REVEL in Christmas merriment,
displayed with such exuberance.

25 TANGUB CITY

Misamis Occidental

What to expect

Creativity and ingenuity as the entire place is covered with lanterns, arches, and other symbols of holiday cheer. A grand view of Panguil Bay from nearby Fertig Hill, Highland Park.

What to do

Enjoy the Christmas spirit to the utmost. Have your fill of shrimps, mud crabs, exotic seafood, evergreen mangoes.

What to wear

Comfortable clothes, sensible footwear, a light jacket.

When to go

November to January, for the Christmas season.

How to get there

Fly from Manila, sail from Cebu, or take a bus from Cagayan de Oro to reach Ozamiz City. From there, take a bus or jeepney to Tangub.

It pays to know

If you want an extra bit of adventure, zipline facilities have been set up near the city.





SCREAM out loud,
absolutely no one will stop you.

26

GLORIA DAPITAN FANTASYLAND
Sunset Boulevard, Dapitan City

What to expect

The nation's biggest theme park
outside of Metro Manila.
35 hair-raising rides.
Nightly entertainment,
fun shopping options.

What to do

Try all the rides, if you can.

What to wear

Comfortable clothes.

When to go

Year-round destination.
The place is best experienced
in the evening.

How to get there

15 minutes from Dapitan port.
Take a tricycle, motorcycle,
or habal-habal.

SPLASH your way through,
and fall in love with each one of
them.

27 BRITANIA GROUP OF ISLANDS

Liang Bay, Surigao del Sur

What to expect

24 islets and islands
of virgin charm.
A true Pacific Ocean
experience.

What to do

Island-hop, swim,
worship the sun.
Take the selfie of your life.

What to wear

Swimwear, sunblock,
Beach footwear.

When to go

Philippine summer season.

How to get there

Fly from Manila to Butuan City.
From the airport, take a van
for a 3 to 4-hour trip to San
Agustin, the take-off point for
Britania.
From Davao City, take a bus
going to Tandag, Surigao del Sur.
San Agustin is along the way
and the trip takes approximately
6 hours.



POWER up and see water
surging down with the greatest
energy.

28 MARIA CRISTINA FALLS

Inside the National Power Nature
Park, Iligan City

What to expect

The primary source of
Mindanao's hydroelectric power.
Water rushing down
98 meters from the top.
Fun facilities, picnic amenities.

What to do

Have a great picnic.
Climb some rocks,
do the zipline.

What to wear

Comfortable clothes,
swimming outfit,
sensible footwear.

When to go

Year-round destination,
Open on Sundays and
special occasions.

How to get there

A 15-minute jeepney ride
from the city center.
Another 30-minute walk
from the park's entrance
to the waterfalls.



TREK through serenity—uplifting, unforgettable experience.

29

LAKE SEBU

Lake Sebu, South Cotabato

What to expect

One of the country's most fascinating lakes. The natural world of the T'boli people.

What to do

Hike up the hills, spend a day at the falls. Sail around the lake on a traditional canoe. Visit the dream weavers. Do the zipline through awesome sights. Enjoy a lakeside drink as dusk arrives.

What to wear

Comfortable clothes, proper hiking footwear, swimming outfit, light jacket for the evening.

When to go

Year-long destination, but it is best visited during the Philippine summer season.

How to get there

Fly from Manila, Cebu or Iloilo to General Santos City. Private vans can be hired to take you straight to the site. Or you can ride a bus from the city center to Koronadal. Then, take another one to the town of Surallah, where vans await to bring visitors to the lake.

It pays to know

Get into the zipline early in the morning, as it tends to rain in the early afternoon. Zipline operations cease when it rains.



LAZE in warm pools, a tonic
and a treat for everyone.

30 MAINIT SULFURIC HOT SPRING

Barangay Mainit, Maco, Compostela Valley

What to expect

A gentle cascade of steaming, healing waters. Natural and manmade pools for you to wade into.

What to do

Take a dip. Daytime picnic. Relax, de-stress, savor the simplicity of the place.

What to wear

Comfortable clothes, swimwear.

When to go

Philippine summer season.

How to get there

From Davao City, take a bus to Tagum City Overland Bus Terminal. Then ride a jeepney or bus going to Massara. Tell the driver to take you to Mainit. The site is just a few minutes' walk from the highway.

PADDLE around islets of charm,
an experience worth sharing.

31 SOHOTON COVE

Bucas Grande Island, Surigao del Norte

What to expect

An enthralling lagoon revealed after passing through a cave. Pristine waters dotted with a multitude of islets.

What to do

Swim, kayak, explore. Stay as long as you wish at resorts nearby.

What to wear

Comfortable clothes, swimwear, sunblock, beach footwear.

When to go

Philippine summer season.

How to get there

Fly from Manila or ride a bus from Davao to reach Surigao City or Butuan City. Then ride any public transport to the port of Hayanggabon located in the town of Claver. From there, take a 45-minute boat ride to Sohoton.

It pays to know

Once in Sohoton Bay, access to freshwater and food supply is limited. Arrange everything beforehand with the resort you wish to stay with.





SWIM your way through crystal-clear, sensational shades of blue.

32

ENCHANTED RIVER Hinatuan, Surigao del Sur

What to expect

Cool saltwater.
Amazing underwater life.
The breathtaking sight of fish coming out of nowhere, feeding to the sound of music every 12:00 NN & 3:00 PM.

What to do

Swim, dive.
Take underwater selfies.
Help feed the fish for a small fee.
Do island-hopping around Hinatuan Bay after your river visit.

What to wear

Comfortable clothes, swimming outfit, sensible footwear.
Wear a snorkel or a swimming mask to better appreciate the underwater sights.
Do not forget to bring an underwater camera.

When to go

June to March, ideally on weekdays when the place is less crowded.

How to get there

Fly from Manila or Cebu or take a bus from Davao City to reach Butuan.
From Butuan, take a bus to Hinatuan.

It pays to know

Night swimming is strongly discouraged by the authorities.

FABRICS, WEAVES, ARTIFACTS & ARTS

KNOW the source,
the country's richest site is right
here.

33 CARAGA GOLD

Caraga is a literal treasure trove. Gold in the greatest abundance can be found underneath its fertile mountains and valleys. It also has the world's most plentiful iron ore deposits, the Philippines' largest source of nickel, as well as bountiful reserves of copper, chromite, and coal.



DISCOVER a way of life expressed in centuries—old burial pottery.

34 MAITUM JAR

A new lease on life—that was what these Metal Age artifacts were given when discovered in 1991 inside Ayub Cave in Maitum. These anthropomorphic secondary burial jars were crafted between 5 BC to 225 AD. Made of clay, they are distinguished by designs that suggest human forms and facial expressions. Some of the jars are decorated with glass beads, shell scoops, spoons, and pendants.





ADORE tribal couture,
worn daily as expressions of
identity.

35 T'BOLI ACCESSORIES

Chandelier-type earrings with
glass beads or shells.
Strands of tiny colored beads
to frame the face.
Black, red, and white bead chokers.
Heirloom neck pieces
made of triple-linked brass chain,
tasseled and beaded at the end.
Bracelets and armbands.
Brass chainmail girdles with
hawk bells that tinkle as you walk.

Where to buy
K'Datu Pasalubong Center
near Lake Sebu church.
Lake View Native Souvenir Shop
along Lake Sebu's main road.

Amazing fact
T'boli females are taught the art
of ornamentation early in life.
Five year olds know how to powder
their faces with lime, and color their
lips with juices from native fruits.

TAKE with you the sound and rhythm that has moved Mindanao for centuries.

36 KULINTANG

From a native signaling tradition, *kulintang* is now in the universe of world music. The main instrument consists of a row of small brass or bronze gongs horizontally laid upon a wooden rack. Accompanying instruments include the *gandang*, the two-headed cylindrical drum, as well as the *duahan agong* pair consisting of the *bua* (a giant-sized gong) and *pulakan* (a narrow-shaped knobbed gong).

Amazing fact

Playing specific pieces of kulintang music is part of a traditional ritual to cure the sick.



37 MARANAO BRASSWARE

Metal is melted in a crude crucible made of a mixture of clay and charcoal. Poured into a clay mold using a technique called the lost wax process. Then, designs are carved on the brassware with a chisel, a curved knife, a small axe. Each piece is a showcase of the *okir*, the flowering and branching motif so beloved in most of Southeast Asia.

Amazing fact

The brass artisans of Tuguya utilize scraps recovered from the bomb casings and ammunition shells from World War II.



SEARCH for art that is part of the fabric of tribal life.

38 MANDAYA DAGMAY

The material is dyed in mud and organic roots, woven by hand, with designs revolving around man and crocodile. Each piece of *dagmay* cloth is unique, an individual artistic expression as it is evidence of a tradition passed on through generations.

Amazing fact

Such is the sacredness of the weave that the Mandaya people wrap their dead in it.



GET a roll of colorful patterns, woven spontaneously and masterfully.

39 BADJAO MATS

No two Badjao mats are ever the same. Dreams inspire the design. Spontaneity is the only pattern at work. These factors make these mats among the country's most precious.

Where to find

If you want to invest in a masterpiece, go to Ungos Matata, Tandubas, in the province of Tawi–Tawi. Get one of the mats woven by Haja Amina Appi, declared by the National Commission on Arts and Culture as a Manlilikha ng Bayan.

BUY a worthy keepsake, lovely cloths infused with hues of tradition.

40 YAKAN FABRIC

Hand–loomed items in bold colors and geometric patterns. Each one is crafted with such skill and meticulous precision.

Where to buy

Yakan Weaving Village, Calarian, Zamboanga

How much

A square foot of a weave can cost between Php400 and Php1,500.



COLLECT a weave of dreams, inspired by the spirits and crafted with care.

41 T'BOLI T'NALAK

It is heritage woven into every square inch, done through the *ikat* method with the use of abaca fiber and natural dyes. Each T'nalak design is a product of time, and is a gift from Fa Dalu, the spirit of the abaca plant.

SUPPORT an art form made of earth, made by visionaries.

42 SOIL PAINTING

Life of a people is portrayed in shades of brown, red, and gray—earth colors best shown with the use of earth itself. Not a single drop of paint, just soil on canvas, some binders, and boundless imagination. Valuable creations by Waway Saway and artists of the Talaandig indigenous community.



ACQUIRE masterpieces created by Mindanao's foremost artist.

43 KUBLAI ARTS

Exuberant paintings, fascinating sculptures, compelling photographs, digital art works—a fine array of pieces from the fertile mind of Kublai Millan.



FOOD & FRUITS

ENJOY luscious sweetness
from the queen of tropical fruits.

44 MANGOSTEEN

What is it

A dark purple, round fruit
around 3 inches in diameter,
about the size of a small apple.

What's in a name

Science calls it
Garcinia mangostana L.
Also known as mangostan.

Season to savor

August to October

Best place to buy

The fruit stalls of Davao City,
especially during the Kadayawan
Festival when fruits are sold at a
cheaper price.



DELIGHT in the tangy sophistication of one of the world's largest citrus fruits.

45 POMELO

What is it?
Large, juicy citrus fruit to be enjoyed on its own, as a shake, or as part of a refreshing salad.

What's in a name?
Citrus maxima

Season to savor
July to September

Best place to buy
Davao City

Bring it home
Stored in the refrigerator, pomelos can last up to a week



FEAST on the legendary richness of this flavorful gift of nature.

47 DURIAN

What is it
Large spiked fruit that grows abundantly in Mindanao.

What's in a name
Its scientific name is Durio zibethinus

Season to savor
August to October

Best place to buy
Fruit stalls in Davao City

Bring it home
At the Davao Airport, packed durian is allowed to be checked in for as long no smell emanates from the luggage.



TRY the subtle creaminess of this exotic, aromatic treat.

46 MARANG

What is it
A soft-spiked fruit native to Mindanao, Palawan and Borneo. It is related to jackfruit, breadfruit and cempedak.

What's in a name
Science calls it Artocarpus odoratissimus
Season to savor
September to December.

Best place to buy
The fruit stalls of Davao City.



INDULGE in artisanal goodness, each slice and bar made with passion.

48 MALAGOS CHEESE & CHOCOLATE

What is it?
Pure, flavorful cheeses including kesong puti, goat cheese processed on the same milking day. 100% pure unsweetened chocolate ideal for drinking and baking. 65% dark chocolate perfect for pastry couverture and for personal enjoyment. These chocolate products are made from Grade A Trinitario cacao.

What's in a name?
Trinitario is a hybrid of Forastero and Criollo varieties.

Season to savor
Available all year round.

Best place to buy
Bolcan Street, Agdao, Davao City

Bring it home
Always store in freezer



TASTE deep-sea crabs elevated to culinary heights by the sauce of Alavar.

49 CURACHA

What is it

Deep-sea crab variety found only in the waters around Zamboanga. It is cooked and served with a savory sauce of made from coconut milk and an array of spices.

Best place to enjoy

Alavar Seafood Restaurant in Zamboanga City.

Bring it home

Alavar sells its famous sauce packed and frozen for easier handling and transport.

How much

A kilogram of Alavar sauce costs about Php250. You can buy a kilo of curacha at the Guiwan Market for about Php450.



SAMPLE a true sensation, a seaweed side dish to remember.

50 SEA GRAPES

What is it

A gift from the sea. Rich in nutrients, interesting texture, delightful to the palate. Mixed with onions, tomatoes, and soy sauce, sea grapes or *lato* salad is the perfect side dish to grilled or fried fish.

Best place to enjoy

Coastal towns and cities in Mindanao



PLEASE your palate with the tastes of history served every day

52 ZAMBOANGA CUISINE

What is it

Spanish colonial dishes adapted and reimagined in a distinctly Zamboangueño way. The resulting menu of paella, jamon, callos, and curacha is a showcase of true cuisine fusion.

Season to savor

Served all year round.

Best place to enjoy

Alavar Seafood Restaurant for the Curacha. Country Chicken for the Paella and Jamon

PICK the freshest catch transformed with into a salad of pure delight.

51 TUNA KINILAW

What is it

Succulent fresh tuna cubes mixed with vinegar, chilies, spices and cucumber slices. The concoction is chilled until the fish portions are cured by the mixture's acidity.

What's in a name

Tuna is a saltwater finfish of the tribe Thunnini, a sub-group of the mackerel family.

Season to savor

Served all year round.



MUNCH on crispy and tasty deep-fried fish.

53 TILAPIA

What is it

Crunchy fish fare that can be enjoyed as part of a meal.

Season to savor

Served all year round.

Best place to enjoy

Punta Isla Lake Resort in Lake Sebu, South Cotabato.





SIP a cup of such rarity,
a blend acclaimed the world
over.

54 CIVET COFFEE

What is it

Beans are picked from droppings of the Philippine civet that eats the ripest coffee cherries whole. Yes, it takes two full cycles of nature before a harvest can be done.

What's in a name

The coffee is named after the local wild animal scientifically called *Paradoxorus philippinensis*.

Season to savor

Available all year round.

Best place to buy/enjoy

Mt. Apo Civet Coffee at Riverfront, Corporate City, Diversion Highway, Ma-a District. Local coffee shops in Davao City.

How much

100g—bottle of Blue Label Civet Coffee Peaberry Beans: Php1,800
100g—bottle of Black Label Civet Coffee Peaberry Beans: Php1,000
100g—bottle of Civet Ground Coffee: Php1,000

EAT the dish enjoyed through time, simmering with all the flavors of tradition.

55 NILOTLOT

What is it

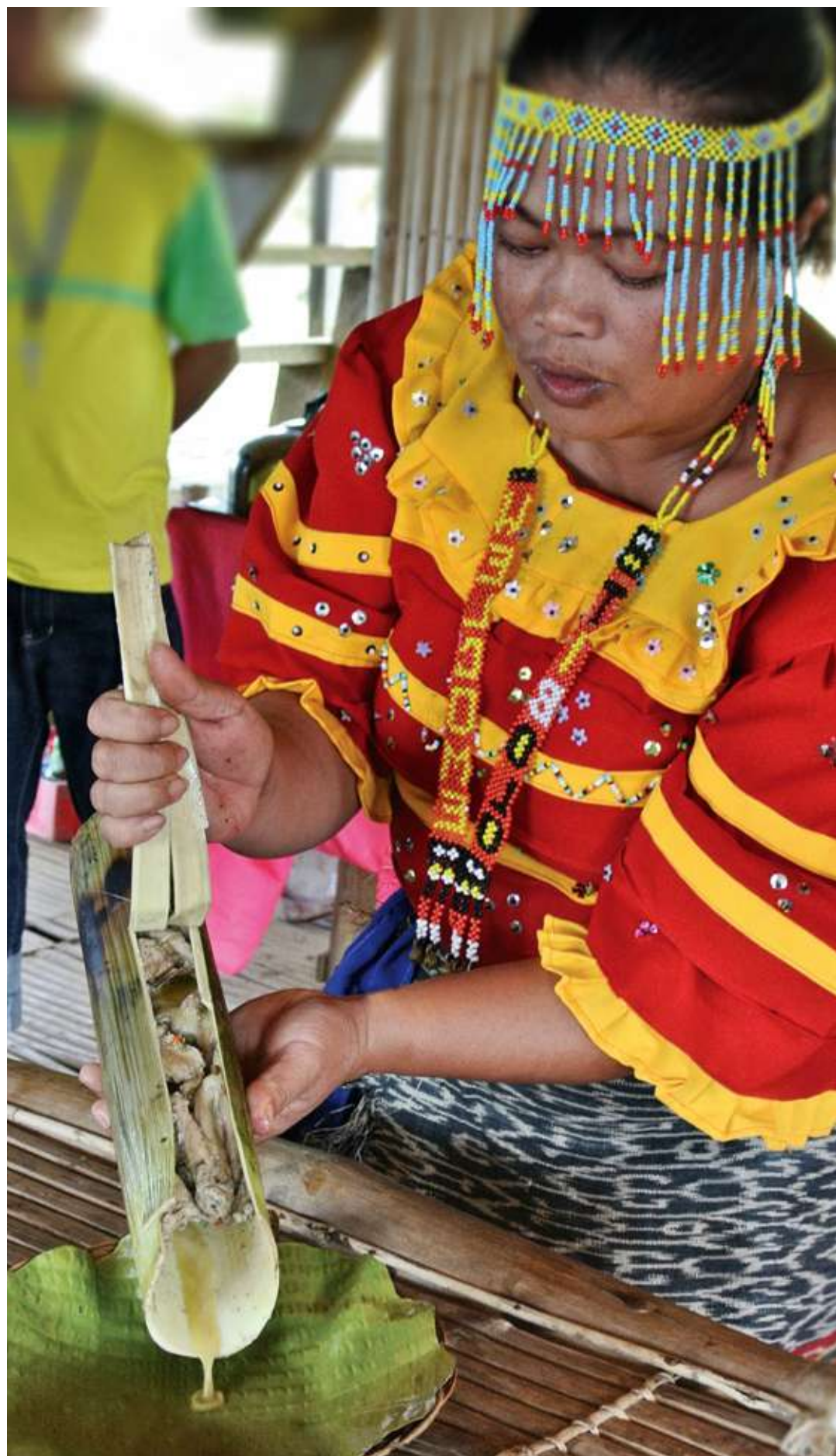
Native chicken cooked in bamboo, a specialty of Davao's tribes. Bite-size chicken pieces are mixed with a pre-sautéed concoction of leeks, turmeric, ginger, onion, salt and coconut milk. Everything is spooned inside a bamboo tube, sealed, and placed over burning charcoal. The resulting dish is a stew of perfection.

Season to savor

Served all year round.

Best place to enjoy

Tibolo Cultural Village in Santa Cruz, Davao del Sur.



SATE your craving

for breakfast beyond the ordinary.

56 SATTI DE ZAMBOANGA

What is it?

Grilled chicken or beef, cubed rice, dripping with Zamboanga's deliciously aromatic satti sauce. It is among the country's most flavorful ways to start your day.

Season to savor

Served all year round.

Best place to enjoy

Jimmy's Satti Haus
Pilar St., Zamboanga City

How much

For Php50, you can buy the basics: 1 tamu (or cubed rice), 3 sticks of grilled beef cut into small cubes. Then you can start adding tamu for Php10 and Php5 for the sticks of grilled beef. You may also add chicken liver and feet to your order.



ORDER a bowl of pride,
a culinary experience worth
having.

57 TIULAH ITUM

What is it

The stew of the Tausug tribe. In the past, this heritage dish is served to mark special events. Beef chunks marinated in a black paste of burnt coconut, turmeric, ginger and lemongrass. The meat is then boiled in water seasoned with salt, black pepper and chilies.

What's in a name

Tiulah itum literally means black soup.

Season to savor

Served all year round.

Where to enjoy

Enjoy it at Barcode Rizal or Barcode Paseo del Mar

How much

Php188/order

SNACK on the crisp rice,
reinvented in the sweetest way.

58 LOKOT-LOKOT

What is it

Rice grains pounded
into fine powder.
Blended with water
and traditional ingredients.
Sweetened, deep-fried
into crunchy rolls.
Best enjoyed with coffee or tea,
it is a snack beloved by all.

Season to savor

Available all year round.

Best place to buy

Enjoy it at Barcode Rizal or Barcode
Paseo del Mar.
Taluksangay Muslim Delicacies
Sampaguita Rd., Tumaga Porcentro,
Zamboanga City.

How much

Box of 12 is Php80
Pack of 10 is Php75

Bring it home

Lokot-Lokot are packed in boxes
for easy transport.



CHEER on authentic diversity showcased by seven different tribes.

59 KAAMULAN FESTIVAL

When
Second half of February until March 10.

What to expect
A grand celebration of the cultures and traditions of the Bukidnon, Higaonon, Talaandig, Manobo, Matigsalug, Tigwahanon and Umayamnon tribes.

Where
Malaybalay City, Bukidnon

How to get there
Fly from Manila or Cebu to Cagayan de Oro City. Then take a 3-hour bus ride to Malaybalay. From the city's Integrated Bus Terminal, get a tricycle to bring you to the downtown area.

FESTIVALS

JOIN the toast for bounty
and the promise of a golden
future.

60 BULAWAN FESTIVAL

When
March 3 – 8

What to expect
An extensive exhibit of tribal
living and traditions.
It features replicas of houses
and cultural artifacts from
the Manobo, Mandaya, Mansaka,
Manguangan, Dibabawon, and
Kalagan communities.
Included in the celebration are
an agro-trade and tourism fair,
women and youth days,
sports competitions,
street dancing.

Where
Nabunturan,
Compostella Valley

How to get there
From Davao City to Nabunturan,
take a bus from the Davao City
Overland Transport Terminal.
Upon arrival at the center,
take a single motorcycle,
or a multi-passenger vehicle
called skylab to take you around
town.

For more information
<http://www.ecomval.gov.ph/tourist/>



GO to a place of pride,
where heritage is woven into the
fabric of life.

61 T'NALAK FESTIVAL

When
July 10 – 18

What to expect
The T'nalak takes center stage
as the celebration weaves together
ethnic diversity and unity of
purpose.
Colorful parades, street dancing,
sporting events, street parties,
and a trade expo featuring
innovative products of the province
await visitors to the festival.

Where
Koronadal, South Cotabato

How to get there
Fly from Manila, Cebu or Iloilo
to General Santos City, then
ride a bus from the city center
to Koronadal.

Don't forget
Practice your Ilonggo, Cebuano
or Ilocano so you'd be able to
enjoy a chat with South Cotabato's
multilingual people.

For more information
<http://tnalakfestival.southcotabato.gov.ph/>





BREATHE in the spirit of
adventure,
a remembrance of fearlessness
and drive.

62 BALANGHAI FESTIVAL

When

The whole month of May.

What to expect

A commemoration of the coming
of pre-colonial seafarers who
eventually settled in the area.
The festival features parades
of colorful and creative costumes,
fantastic floats, and exotic
performances.

Where

Butuan City

How to get there

Fly from Manila or Cebu.
Take a bus from
Davao or Cagayan de Oro.
To reach the city center
from Butuan's Bancasi airport,
ride a multicab with an R4
signboard.



LISTEN to pure intensity—
in every note, instrument, and key.

63 MUSIKAHAN FESTIVAL

When
February 21 – March 7

What to expect
Mindanao's premier music festival. Battle of the bands and an array of contests for songwriters, choirs, and quartets. Also included in the set list are competitions for brass bands, drum and bugle corps, and the Rondal–Awit.

Where
Tagum City, Davao del Norte

How to get there
Fly from Manila or Cebu to Davao City. Take a bus from the Overland Transport Terminal to Tagum City. Or you can reach the place via land transport from all points of Mindanao.



SATISFY your gastronomic curiosity
with this buffet of culinary creativity.

64 KUMBIRA: CULINARY SHOW AND LIVE COMPETITION

When
August 14 – 16

What to expect
Live culinary competition. Chef Wars exhibition. Culinary trade exhibit with free food sampling and cooking demonstrations. Interactive booth allowing visitors to witness a short demo and participate in hands-on activities. Kumbira Moments photo contest. Seminars on food, beverage, and hospitality.

Where
Atrium of Limketkai Mall,
Cagayan de Oro City

How to get there
Fly to Manila, Cebu, Davao, or Iloilo to Cagayan de Oro City. Upon arrival, take a shuttle to the city center.

For more information
www.cohara.org

RIDE the wave of excitement
of this colorful race for glory.

65 REGATTA DE ZAMBOANGA

When
Every October

What to expect
A highlight of the Zamboanga Hermosa celebration. Vintas of all patterns and hues racing along the shores of the city. A spectacle not to be missed.

Where
The shoreline along R. T. Lim Boulevard.

How to get there
To Zamboanga, there are regular flights from Manila, Cebu, and Davao City. From the city's airport, ride a jeepney or tricycle to the center of town.





STEP into a world of historical battles, miracles, and modern-day pageants.

66 KINABAYO FESTIVAL

When
July 25

What to expect
A commemoration of the victory of Christian Spanish forces over the Moors, attributed to the apparition of St. James on horseback, carrying a sword. The festival also features agro-trade fairs, street parties, sporting competitions, concerts, and a beauty pageant.

Where
Dapitan City,
Zamboanga del Norte

How to get there
Fly to Dipolog City. From the airport, ride a mini-bus or van to Dapitan City.

For more information
<http://kinabayo.dapitancity.gov.ph>

LIFT your spirits with this enthralling tribute to a pioneer.

67 SHARIFF KABUNSUAN FESTIVAL

When
December 15 – 19

What to expect
A true historical milestone. This festival marks the introduction of Islam to Mindanao with the arrival of an Arab missionary 500 years ago. At present, activities include an Islamic culinary competition, kulintang ensemble contest, ethnic sporting events, Inaul fashion show, a trade fair, the Alimango (crab) Festival, boat races, and even the Philippine Legend Acrobatic Show.

Where
Cotabato City

How to get there
Fly from Manila, or take a bus from Davao City. Upon reaching the Cotabato City Airport, ride a multicab or a jeepney to reach the downtown area





GROOVE to the rhythm
of a people united in
thanksgiving.

68 SAMBUOKAN FESTIVAL

When

Week of October 29

What to expect

A show of unity by a people
of diverse cultural backgrounds.
A week's worth of shows and
fun activities. It also features a
street dancing competition called
Indak-indak sa Sambuokan.

Where

Mati City, Davao Oriental

How to get there

Take a bus from Davao to Mati City.
from the bus terminal, ride a
tricycle to the town center.

Don't forget

Bring loads of swimwear.
There are a lot of beaches
in the area.

For more information

[http://mati.gov.ph/IT_MatiOffice/
sambuokan-festival](http://mati.gov.ph/IT_MatiOffice/sambuokan-festival)



REJOICE with the faithful
in this pageant of Marian
adoration.

69 ZAMBOANGA LA HERMOSA

When
October 1 – 12

What to expect
Honoring Nuestra Señora del Pilar,
this is one of the Philippines' oldest
festivals.
Festivities include religious parades,
an exciting regatta, and a hotly-
anticipated street dance contest
participated by a lot of the city's
many schools.

Where
Zamboanga City

How to get there
To Zamboanga, there are
regular flights from Manila,
Cebu, and Davao City.
From the city's airport,
ride a jeepney or tricycle
to the center of town.

For more information
[http://www.philippinecountry.com/
philippine_festivals/zamboanga_
hermosa_festival.ht](http://www.philippinecountry.com/philippine_festivals/zamboanga_hermosa_festival.ht)

WALK with the devout
in a Lenten expression of
penitence.

70 PANAAD FESTIVAL

When

Every Holy Thursday
and Good Friday

What to expect

A 64-kilometer walk by the road
that circles the entire island,
and an arduous trek up Mt. Vulcan
where one can walk the station of
the cross.
Superb views of the sea,
refreshing breeze, an unmistakably
spiritual experience.

Where

Camiguin Island

How to get there

There are flights from Cebu City
to Camiguin, or you can choose
to fly to Cagayan de Oro City.
Upon arrival, take a shuttle to
Agora Terminal where a bus
will take you to Balingoan Port.
Take a ferry to Benoni Port in
Camiguin. From the port area,
ride a motorela to the capital,
Mambajao.

Don't forget

Make sure to bring bottles of water
to hydrate yourself as you do the
walk.



LOVE the sheer joy
of one of the country's biggest
celebrations.

71 KADAYAWAN FESTIVAL

When

Every 3rd week of August

What to expect

This series of events commemorate Davao's centuries-old tradition of ethnic tribes converging at the foot of Mt. Apo to thank Manama, the supreme being, for a bountiful harvest.

Outstanding displays of merriment include floral floats, tourism exhibits, a dazzling parade of tribal costumes, and a day-long street dancing festival called Indak-indak sa Kadalanan.

Where

Davao City

How to get there:

Fly from Manila, Cebu, Iloilo, Bacolod, Cagayan de Oro, Zamboanga City, and Singapore. Or ride a bus from all points in Mindanao.

WITNESS faith and fanfare
blending in the most unique
Filipino–Muslim way.

72 PAKARADJAAN FESTIVAL

When
October 24 – 31

What to expect
Qur'an reading, azan competition, kulintangan contest, a pageant of the smartest Muslim ladies of the region.

Where
Isabela City, Basilan

How to get there
Fly from Manila, Cebu or Davao to Zamboanga City. Take a ferry to Isabela City from Zamboanga Port.

Don't forget
Bring extra cash for irresistible souvenir and food items on sale.



PARTY your way
through four days of sun, sand,
and sizzle.

73 SARANGANI BAY FESTIVAL

When
Third weekend of May

What to expect
From sundown to sunrise, the most fun party in the entire island of Mindanao. It's like clubbing on white sand, with the sound of the sea mixing with the turntable beats of DJs on board.

Where
Gumasa Beach
Glan, Sarangani Province

How to get there
Fly from Manila, Cebu, or Iloilo, or take a bus from Davao to reach General Santos City. Ride a van from KCC Mall to Glan, then a tricycle to Gumasa.

Don't forget
It's cool to tent it on the beach if you've got no place to stay.



CATCH the irresistible spirit powering an industry to prominence.

74 TUNA FESTIVAL

When

Week of September 5

What to expect

Tuna Congress, Fiesta Carnival, Culinary Skills competition, Sashimi Night, BodyFest modeling tilt, Miss GenSan Pageant, the Fish Dance contest, and parades of tuna-inspired floats.

Where

General Santos City

How to get there

Fly from Manila, Cebu, or Iloilo, take a bus from Davao to reach General Santos City.

Don't forget

Catch the early morning buzz at the Fishport Complex, where fishermen haul in tuna in varying sizes, some as heavy as 80 kilos.



SADDLE up for the chase—horses, cowboys, and some good old fun.

75 RODEO FESTIVAL

When

Third week of August

What to expect

Days of rodeo competition, with all the thrill and frenzy one expects from such manly display of skill and determination.

Where

Impasug-ong, Bukidnon

How to get there

Fly from Manila or Cebu to Cagayan de Oro City. Then take a 3-hour bus ride to Impasug-ong. From the city's Integrated Bus Terminal, get a tricycle to bring you to the downtown area.

ECO- ADVENTURE

PLUNGE into the real thing—
a spine-tingling, rip-roaring
adventure.

76 CDO WATER RAFTING

Where

Barangay Mambuaya,
Cagayan de Oro City.

How to get there

Fly from Manila, Cebu, Davao,
or Iloilo to Cagayan de Oro City.
Upon arrival, take a shuttle to
the city center where a ride will take
you to the rafting site.

What to expect

A natural rollercoaster ride.
Intervals of rapids between
10 to 15 minutes of each other.

Best time to go

Year-round destination,
peak season from
June to December.

What to wear

Beachwear, rash guards,
quick-drying clothes.
Aqua shoes or
strapped sandals.
Wear sunblock.

How much will it cost

About 700 pesos per person,
minimum of 6 people.

For more information

[http://www.
raftingadventurephilippines.com/
whitewater-rafting-cagayandeoro.
html](http://www.raftingadventurephilippines.com/whitewater-rafting-cagayandeoro.html)

SOAR to the heavens,
enjoy the view of the world
below.

77 SARANGANI PARAGLIDING

Where

Safi Ranch Paragliding Fly Site,
Barangay Seguil, Maasim,
Sarangani Province

How to get there

Fly from Manila, Cebu, or Iloilo,
take a bus from Davao to reach
General Santos City.
Take a public utility van bound for
Maasim at ABLOG terminal, tell
the driver to drop you off at SAFI
Shipyard.

What to expect

Take off at a spot
950 feet above sea level.

Best time to go

The best time to fly is
from 7:00 to 10:00 AM,
and from 3:00 to 5:00 PM.

What to wear

Comfortable clothes,
sensible footwear.

How much will it cost

Php3,000/person, includes
transportation from Maasim to the
site, flying equipment, pilot's fee,
video of the flight.
Please bring a flash drive or
a memory card for the video
transfer.

It pays to know

Make your reservations 2 to 3 days
before your desired schedule.
A minimum of 2 persons is needed
to confirm a booking.

For more information

[www.facebook.com/sarangani.
paraglide](https://www.facebook.com/sarangani.paraglide)





CONQUER the summit
of the nation's highest mountain.

78 MT. APO

Where

Kidapawan—Magpet Trail,
from Barangay Ilomavis,
Kidapawan City.
There are also trails from Davao del
Sur and Davao City.

How to get there

Fly from Manila, Cebu, Iloilo,
Bacolod, Cagayan de Oro,
Zamboanga City, and Singapore
to reach Davao City.
Go to Ecoland Bus Terminal
and take a bus to Kidapawan City.

What to expect

A 3-day trek to the top,
3,144 meters above sea level.

Best time to go

Philippine summer season.

What to wear

Expert-approved climbing gear.

How much will it cost

Around Php6,500 for two persons.

It pays to know

Climbers need to register at the
Kidapawan Tourism Office for a
seminar and briefing.

For more information

[http://www.mtapoadventures.com/
tour-packages/](http://www.mtapoadventures.com/tour-packages/)



RIDE through humps and bumps,
a thriller with no speed limits.

79 MAITUM WATER TUBING

Where

New La Union,
Maitum, Sarangani Province

How to get there

Fly from Manila, Cebu, or Iloilo,
or take a bus from Davao
to reach General Santos City.
Take a public utility van bound for
Maitum.
Then ride a habal-habal to New La
Union tubing site.

What to expect

1.6 kilometers of wet and wild fun.

Best time to go

Philippine rainy season.
After a downpour, river currents are
stronger due to rising water levels.

What to wear

Beachwear, quick-drying clothes.
Aqua shoes or strapped sandals.
Wear sunblock and mosquito
repellent.

How much will it cost

About Php200 per person,
includes use of a helmet
and a life vest, plus the fee
for the river guide.

It pays to know

The ride is best enjoyed
with a group.

For more information

[http://www.sarangani.gov.ph/town/
maitum.html](http://www.sarangani.gov.ph/town/maitum.html)



SURF through the barrel,
as the world paddles out for
more.

80 SIARGAO CLOUD 9

Where

General Luna,
Siargao Island

How to get there

Fly from Manila or Cebu,
or ride a bus from Davao
to reach Surigao City.
Take a ferry to Siargao Island.
Fly from Cebu to Siargao.
Upon arrival at Dapa Port,
get a ride to General Luna.

What to expect

World-renowned Cloud 9,
stunning scenery,
fun-filled days and nights.

What to wear

Board shorts, rash guards,
rubber surfing boots.

How much will it cost

Surfboard rental at
Php500 a day.
Surfing instruction at Php500 per
hour, includes surfboard rental.



SPIN over beautiful waves
and land on a stretch of lovely sand.

81 DAHICAN SKIMBOARDING

Where

Dahican, Mati City,
Davao Oriental

How to get there

Fly from Manila, Cebu, Iloilo,
Bacolod, Cagayan de Oro,
Zamboanga City, and Singapore
to reach Davao City.
Then, take a bus to Mati.
From the bus terminal, ride a
habal–habal straight to
Dahican beach.

What to expect

Perfect waves,
wide sandy beach,
clear blue waters.

Best time to go

October, when skimboarding
competitions are held.

What to wear

Board shorts, t–shirts or rash
guards.

How much will it cost

Php400 for 1 hour of
skimboarding instruction
and board rental.

It pays to know

There is no entrance fee
to Dahican beach.

SURGE through wild currents,
and feel that natural high.

82 DAVAO RIVER WATER RAFTING

Where

Davao Wild Water Adventure,
Crocodile Park, Davao City

How to get there

Fly from Manila, Cebu, Iloilo,
Bacolod, Cagayan de Oro,
Zamboanga City, and Singapore
to reach Davao City.
At the airport, take a taxi
to the Crocodile Park.

What to expect

13 kilometers of adrenaline
rush.

When to go

Year–round destination.

What to wear

Beachwear, rash guards,
quick–drying clothes.
Aqua shoes or
strapped sandals.
Wear sunblock.

How much will it cost

Php2,000 per person

It pays to know

Every rafter is expected to
paddle, following the expert
guide’s instructions.

For more information

<http://www.psdgroupph.com>
<http://crocodilepark.ph/>





FLIP up, down, all around—
all day long and all year round.

83 DECA WAKEBOARDING

Where

Tacunan Road, Mintal,
Davao City

How to get there

Fly from Manila, Cebu, Iloilo,
Bacolod, Cagayan de Oro,
Zamboanga City, and Singapore
to reach Davao City.
At the airport, take a taxi
to Bankerohan.
Ride a van to Deca Wakeboard Park.

What to expect

Water sports at its most fun.

When to go

Year—round destination.

What to wear

Wetsuit or board shorts,
sunglasses or goggles,
gloves, aqua socks,
sunblock.

How much will it cost

Weekdays: from Php400 for 2 hours
to Php600 for 8 hours.
Weekends: from Php500 for 2 hours
to Php750 for 8 hours.

For more information

<http://www.decawakeboardpark.com/about.html>



SMILE and say hello
to the most adorable creatures
of the sea.

84 DOLPHIN WATCHING

Where

Dahican, Mati City,
Davao Oriental

How to get there

From Mati's bus terminal
in Madang, ride a habal–habal
straight to Dahican beach.

What to expect

Dolphins during their mating
season, dugongs, turtles, whale
sharks.

Best time to go

June to September

What to wear

Comfortable clothes,
swimwear.

How much will it cost

Php600 per person,
minimum of 10 people.
The fee includes a trip to
three islands and use of
snorkeling and scuba gear.

It pays to know

The trip to see the dolphins
starts early in the morning,
before sunrise.

For more information

Mati City Tourism Office
+6387 3883234
matitourismoffice@yahoo.com



FLY over seven sublime waterfalls
with Southeast Asia's highest zipping facility.

85 LAKE SEBU ZIPLINE

Where
Purok Pag-asa, Lake Sebu,
South Cotabato

How to get there
Fly from Manila, Cebu or Iloilo
to General Santos City.
Private vans can be hired to
take you straight to the area.
Or you can ride a bus from
the city center to Koronadal.
Then, take another one to
the town of Surallah,
where you can ride a van or
a habal-habal to the site.

What to expect
Over 1,000 meters of zipping,
unforgettable sights as you
go along.

Best time to go
Philippine summer season

What to wear
Comfortable clothes.

How much will it cost
Php250 per person on
weekdays.
Php300 per person on
weekends.

For more information
<http://lakesebu.southcotabato.org/>

SHARE the fun with exciting
choices lined up for everyone.

87 MAPAWA ADVENTURE PARK

Where
Malasag, Brgy. Cugman,
Cagayan de Oro City

How to get there
Fly from Manila, Cebu, Davao,
or Iloilo to Cagayan de Oro City.
Upon arrival, take a shuttle to
the city center. From there,
it takes 30 minutes to reach
Mapawa.

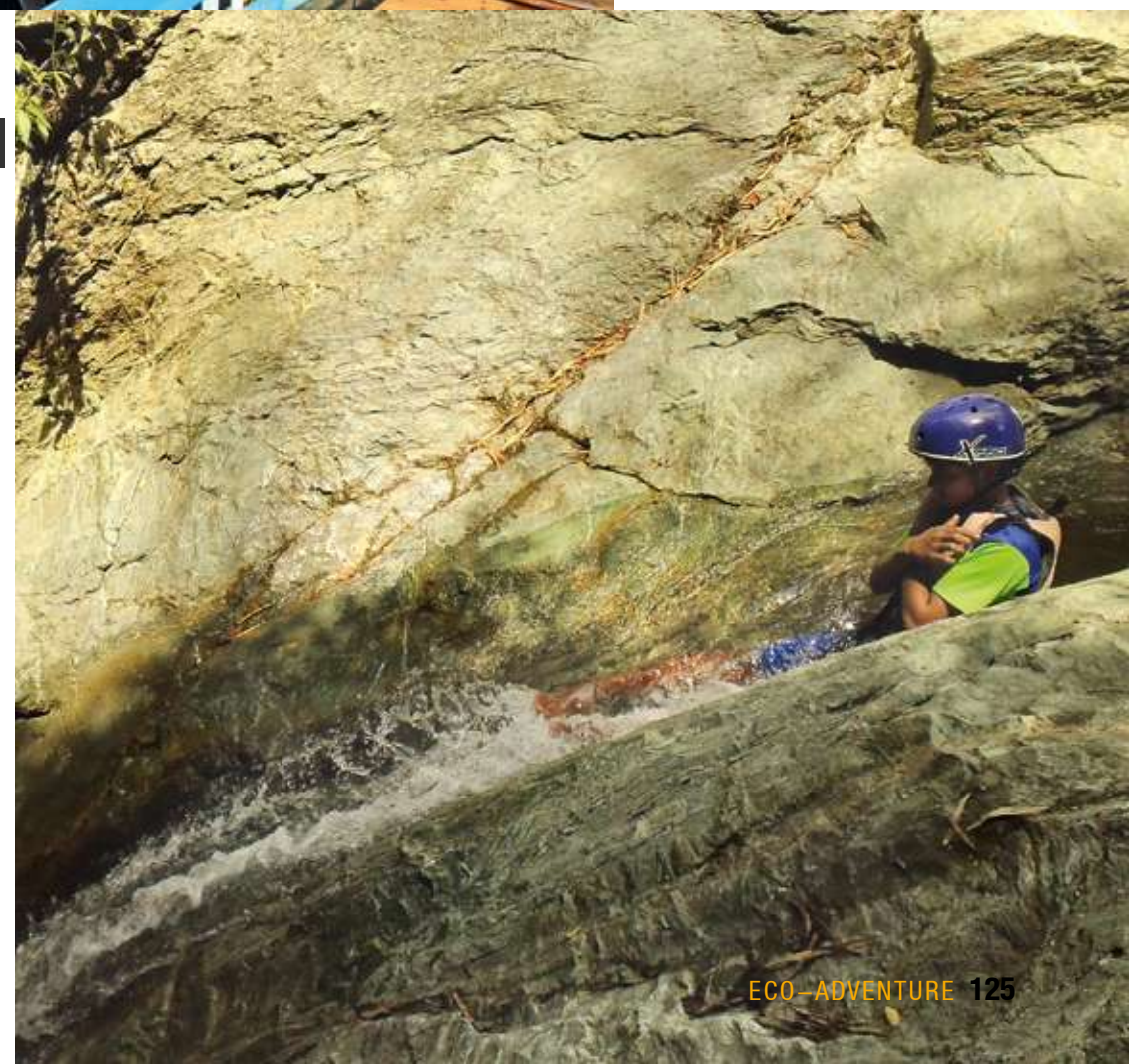
What to expect
Waterfalls, splendid views,
activities to choose from,
a big swimming pool.

Best time to go
Philippine summer season.
Open from 7:00 AM to 5:00 PM
every day of the week.

What to wear
Comfortable clothes,
Swimwear

How much will it cost
Park entrance fee: Php50
Horseback riding: Php200/ hour
Zipline: Php325
Canyoneering: Php1,200

For more information
<http://www.mapawa.com/about-mapawa-adventure/>



SEIZE the most impressive
catch, with a multitude of
species to choose from.

86 GAME FISHING

Where
Pilar, Siargao Islands,
Surigao del Norte

How to get there
Fly from Manila or Cebu,
or ride a bus from Davao
to reach Surigao City.
Take ferry to Siargao Island.
Upon arrival at Dapa Port,
get a jeepney or habal-habal
to take you to Pilar.

What to expect
An abundance of tuna, mackerel,
marlin, grouper, stingray, octopus,
squids and crabs.
The annual International Game
Fishing Tournament of the
Philippines is held here.

Best time to go
Philippine summer season.

What to wear
Comfortable clothes, sensible footwear,
fishing gloves, hats, sunglasses,
sunblock.

For more information
<http://www.siargaofishing.com>

DARE to brave
the country's most grueling race.

88 MT. APO BOULDER FACE CHALLENGE

Where

Santa Cruz, Davao del Sur

How to get there

Fly from Manila, Cebu, Iloilo, Bacolod, Cagayan de Oro, Zamboanga City, and Singapore to reach Davao City. It takes about 1 hour of travel from the city center to Santa Cruz.

What to expect

113.3-kilometer race of a lifetime. Biking, trail running, water tubing, and road running from the beaches of Sta. Cruz the heights of Mt. Apo. A true adventure for the fearless, to be finished within 24 hours.

When

Last weekend of April

What to wear

Expert-approved gear for each leg of the race.

How much will it cost

Php5,000 per team.

For more information

<http://boulderface.com/>



ROPE your way down—
inch by inch, to the river from the
bridge.

89 BUKIDNON RAPELLING

Where

San Jose, Quezon,
Bukidnon Province

How to get there

A 4 to 5-hour bus ride from Cagayan de Oro City. A 3 to 4-hour bus ride from the Davao City Overland Transport Terminal.

What to expect

155-foot descent into the swirling, swishing waters of Pulangi River.

Best time to go

Year-round activity.

What to wear

Comfortable clothes, closed-toe athletic shoes.

How much will it cost

Php350 per person.

GLIDE over earth,
aboard the coolest ultra-light
craft around.

90 FLYING GECKO

Where
Camp 3, Manolo Fortich,
Bukidnon

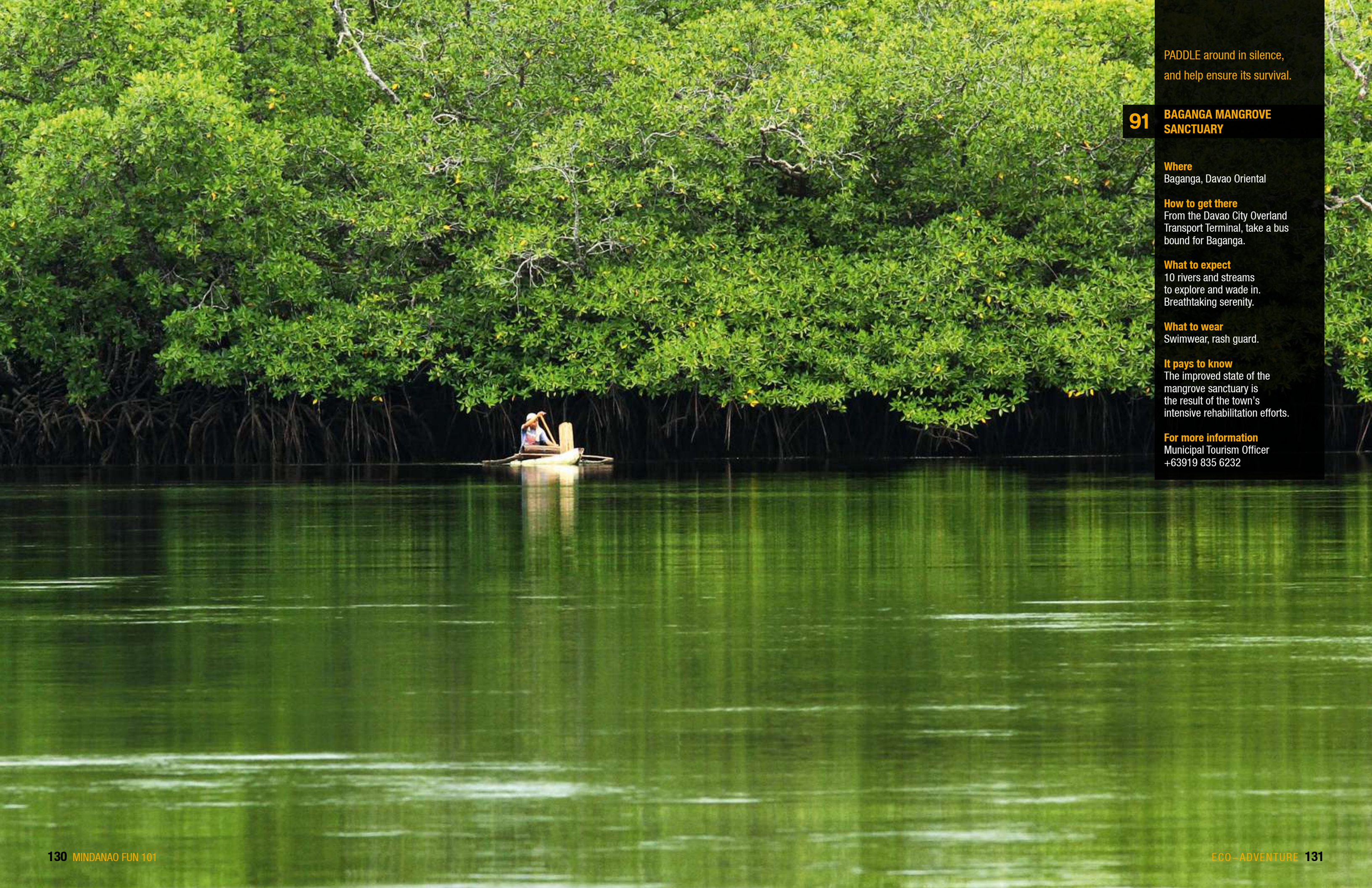
How to get there
A 3-hour bus ride from
Davao City to Manolo Fortich.

What to expect
A 15-minute airborne adventure.
Fabulous views of Bukidnon
and Libona from above.

What to wear
Comfortable clothes,
sensible shoes.

How much will it cost
Php950 per person.





PADDLE around in silence,
and help ensure its survival.

91

BAGANGA MANGROVE SANCTUARY

Where

Baganga, Davao Oriental

How to get there

From the Davao City Overland
Transport Terminal, take a bus
bound for Baganga.

What to expect

10 rivers and streams
to explore and wade in.
Breathtaking serenity.

What to wear

Swimwear, rash guard.

It pays to know

The improved state of the
mangrove sanctuary is
the result of the town's
intensive rehabilitation efforts.

For more information

Municipal Tourism Officer
+63919 835 6232



WATCH creatures of all kinds
in a haven they call home.

92 AGUSAN MARSH WILDLIFE SANCTUARY

Where

Agusan Marsh, Agusan del Sur

How to get there

From Davao City, Butuan, and Surigao del Sur, take a bus to San Francisco.

Take a ride to Barangay Caimpugan.

From there, a small motorized boat will bring you to the heart of the marsh.

What to expect

One of the country's largest freshwater catch basins. Shallow lakes and ponds.

The refuge of the rare Rufous-lored kingfisher, Oriental Darter, Spotted Imperial pigeon, Purple Swamp hen, and the Philippine hawk. Habitat of wild ducks, herons, and egrets.

Best time to go

Year-round destination.

What to wear

Comfortable clothes, sensible shoes.

How much will it cost

A day tour costs Php1,500 plus Php1,000 for the guide.

SCALE the heights of spirituality,
a point of prayer and meditation.

93 BUD BONGAO

Where

Bongao, Tawi-Tawi Province

How to get there

Fly from Manila, Cebu, or Davao to Zamboanga City. Then, take another flight to Sanga-Sanga Airport. From there, ride a tricycle to Bongao. There are also ferry trips from Zamboanga to Bongao 3 times a week.

What to expect

A mountain held sacred by Filipino Muslims of Tawi-Tawi. From the summit, a wondrous view of the Sulu Sea and a faint outline of Malaysia.

Best time to go

Year-round destination. An early morning climb is recommended.

What to wear

Comfortable clothes, trekking footwear.

How much will it cost

There are no standard rates for guides, but your generosity will be greatly appreciated.





SEARCH for rareness,
the largest bloom in the world.

94 RAFFLESIA

Where

Mt. Candalaga, Maragusan,
Compostella Valley

How to get there

Ride a bus from Davao City
to Tagum. Then, take another
bus bound for Maragusan.

What to expect

A day trek up the mountain
to spot the rare Rafflesia Mira
and the newly-discovered
variety, Rafflesia Magnifica.
Blooming in the wild,
making their presence
felt through sheer size
and odor.

Best time to go

September to October.

What to wear

Comfortable clothes,
hiking shoes.

For more information

[http://www.ecomval.gov.ph/
maragusan/](http://www.ecomval.gov.ph/maragusan/)





BRAVE the unknown,
and see nature's deepest secrets.

95 NEW CORELLA CAVES

Where

New Corella, Davao del Norte

What to expect

6 astonishing show caves—Bonduc, Tibyon, Paradise, Bongsit, Tinagong Busay, Borja—now open for you to explore. They are part of more than 100 caves mapped in the area.

Best time to go

Year-round destination.

What to wear

Helmet. Hands-free lighting device.

Protective overalls. The rest of the clothes you will wear will depend on the type of cave you are planning to go to.

It pays to know

You must first register at the Municipal Tourism Office of New Corella, where you will have a pre-exploration briefing. You also need to pay for caving fees.

TROT through trails,
sloping up and down the greenest hills.

96 KAAMULAN PARK HORSEBACK RIDING

Where

Kaamulan Park,
Malaybalay City, Bukidnon

How to get there

From Davao or Cagayan de Oro, take a bus to Malaybalay. Take a tricycle to Kaamulan Park.

What to expect

Horseback riding in a trail around the 500-hectare tree park.

Best time to go

Year-round destination. Stay more than one night to enjoy the place fully.

What to wear

Comfortable clothes, sensible shoes, a light sweater.

How much will it cost

Php100 per hour.





OBSERVE the surge—
the world's largest colony ready
for flight.

97 MONFORT BAT SANCTUARY

Where

Barangay Tambo, Babak District,
Samal Island, Davao del Norte

How to get there

From Davao City, take the
Samal Island City Express
bus/ferry service all the way
to the island. At the wharf,
hire a habal—habal to bring you
to the site.

What to expect

Over 2 million of Geoffroy's
Rousette fruit bats living in a single
cave.

Best time to go

Year-round destination.
The place may be closed
if the weather is not good.

What to wear

Comfortable clothes,
sensible footwear.

How much will it cost

Environmental fee of Php5.
Sanctuary entrance fee of Php100.

It pays to know

The sanctuary offers
wildlife conservation workshops.



WHISTLE with birds of all feathers, flapping about in a dance of love.

98 BARAS BIRD SANCTUARY

Where

Tacurong, Sultan Kudarat

How to get there

From Koronadal City, take a short bus ride to Tacurong. Then, ride a tricycle to the entrance of the sanctuary.

What to expect

Thousands of egrets, a wide variety of other birds.

Best time to go

Philippine summer season
Break of dawn, around 5:00 AM, before the birds fly out to feed or just before sundown, between 4:00 and 5:30 PM when they come back to call it a day.

What to wear

Comfortable clothes, a cap or umbrella to protect you from bird droppings.

How much will it cost

Entrance fee of Php20.



DIVE into the magnificence,
a world of color, movement,
mystery.

99 DAVAO DIVING

Where

Around Talikud and Samal islands,
900 meters east of Davao City.

How to get there

From Davao City's airport,
ride a taxi to Sta. Ana Wharf
near Magsaysay Park.
Then, take a motorized boat
to Santa Cruz, the main port
of Talikud Island.

What to expect

Corals in all shades and sizes,
schools of fish, seahorses,
starfish, iridescent jelly fish.

When to go

Year-round destination.
The months of November
to May offer the best visibility,
especially for underwater
photography.

What to wear

Proper diving gear.

How much will it cost

Php750 inclusive of a round-trip
boat ride, use of diving equipment
and snorkeling gear, instructor's fee,
underwater photos.



COOL down to rev up—
all it takes is a bit of a splash.

100 LAKE SEBU FALLS

Where

Barangay Siloton,
Lake Sebu, South Cotabato

How to get there

From General Santos City, private vans can be hired to take you straight to the site. Or you can ride a bus from the city center to Koronadal. Then, take another one to the town of Surallah, where habal–habal awaits to bring visitors to the area.

What to expect

Seven cascades you can trek to. Invigorating water sensation. Fresh forest air.

What to wear

Comfortable, quick drying clothes, swimwear, sunblock, sensible footwear.

How much will it cost

Entrance fee starts at Php15 for students with ID.

For more info

<http://www.southcotabato.gov.ph/falls-hopping/>



WONDER at the richness
of one of Earth's heritage sites.

101 MT. HAMIGUITAN RANGE WILDLIFE SANCTUARY

Where
Occupies the land area within Barangay La Union in San Isidro, Mati City, and Governor Generoso in Davao Oriental

What to expect
Paradise found in a 6,834-hectare sanctuary. Centuries-old pygmy trees. 1,381 species of flora and fauna including the Philippine eagle, warty pig, brown deer, golden crown flying fox, tarsier, cockatoo, and the mossy-pygmy fruit bat.

It pays to know
For now, the sanctuary is not open to the general public. Only scientists, researchers, and environment advocacy partners are allowed to enter Mindanao's first UNESCO World Heritage Site.

For more information
<http://sanisidro.gov.ph/davaos-mt-hamiguitan-named-unesco-world-heritage-site/>



ACKNOWLEDGMENT

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